



Drake pushes for Hotline Bling emoji

Drake played Fortnite with Ninja and promised to rap about the game if a 'Hotline Bling' emoji was added. <https://digit.in/hotlinebling>



Possible Marvel Game Universe

The Spider-Man game's impending launch on the PS4 may have led to setting up a Marvel Game Universe. <https://digit.in/margameuni>

Game Audio Designers:

Game Audio designers enhance your entire gaming experience with their expertise in audio engineering.

None of these roles are carved in stone. A successful sound engineer should be able to work in all of these roles interchangeably.

AWESOME! HOW DO I START?

Don't understand the difference between a bar and a block? My friend, I have some news for you...

You can still be a sound engineer!

There are formal certification courses that teach you all you need to know about sounds, music and its soul. In India, a 12th standard science student with physics, chemistry and mathematics as compulsory subjects can pursue sound engineering as a bachelor degree. Post that, there are a Masters and Doctoral level courses available from Indian and foreign institutes.

Premier institutes offering sound engineering as a bachelor degree course in India include IIT-Kharagpur, FTI-Pune, National Institute of Film and Fine Arts-Kolkata to name a few. Foreign institutes are a dime a dozen in this industry.

Sound engineering is a field where your academic qualifications are enough to land you an entry-level job at a production house. To make a mark in this industry the work and projects you have taken up speak volumes (no pun intended).

Even if you are not a science student, fret not. There are several industry acknowledged private certifications you can pursue from Indian and international universities. The final and most difficult route is directly on the job. You will face a steep learning curve and have to work that much harder, but it is certainly possible.

Jonathan Rebeiro, who followed an unconventional route to becoming a sound engineer, says, "I began by working in a friend's studio and spent a year just honing my skills till I met an engineer/studio owner at an engineering seminar who hired me.

That's when I technically began my professional career as an assistant engineer and worked my way up". He was an aspiring musician before he switched roles and has worked on the audio engineering of ad campaigns like Vodafone and Pepsi. His body of work also includes movies like 2 States and Bhaag Milkha Bhaag.

To be a good sound engineer, you will need to possess a working understanding of computers and electronics, electronic equipment, computer applications etc. It will be helpful to have an understanding of the theory and techniques required to compose, produce, and perform works of music, dance and other art forms that require sound.

WANT TO BE A SOUND ENGINEER FROM YOUR COUCH?

There are a number of apps out there that will let you mix a few tracks from the comfort of your phone. Try these free sound editing apps for fun and feel the music. This could be your first step into the world of sound engineering. Some apps you can use are Acoustica, Audacity, Audio Tool, TuneKitten Audio Editor. It's time for some funky tunes!

OK SO FAR SO GOOD, NOW WHERE DO I WORK?

The industries you would typically be working in are media and entertainment, production houses, hotels/malls etc.

As a sound engineer, you have a plethora of roles to choose from. Your options include-Sound Recordist, Music Arranger, Sound Designer, Mixing Engineer, Sound Engineer, Live Sound Engineer, Audio Engineer, Studio Manager, Location Recordist, Promo Producer, Radio Sound Engineer or Studio Designer.

"My advice is don't try to do everything. Find out your niche and excel in it", said Rohit Pradhan, winner of a Filmfare award and sound designer for the upcoming movie *Thackeray*.

The rise of usage and development of voice assistant apps like Google Now, Siri, Cortana etc. have opened up avenues that require a professional sound engineer on the team giving rise to a new age industry for sound engineers to shine in. Another new and interesting role is that of an acoustical consultant where you will work with architects to manage and control the noises and vibrations at home and workplace. A demanding yet highly-paid and satisfying job.

A TYPICAL DAY IN THE LIFE OF A SOUND ENGINEER

Here's what a day in the life of most sound engineers would look like especially if you work out of a recording studio, which is where most start off to hone their skills.

We would think that a sound engineer would be sitting behind a large mixing board for most part of the day but a large chunk of their day is spent on creating a feel-good environment for the artist to ensure good recording on the artist's part. The engineer has to be in charge of all his equipment and ensure that the artist is being heard clearly and that the client's brief is being fulfilled during the recording.

During the editing phase, it is the sound engineer's responsibility to mix and match the best takes of the recording. Editing is where most of the magic happens. Mixing the track comes next. At this stage, the sound engineer will attempt to get balance right without letting any one single aspect overpower the others. An arduous task, but rewarding nonetheless.

A smart audio engineer will leave time out at the end of the day to network. Networking brings recommendations and work your way. For all you know, one day you could be sitting in the studio and the next day you could be on tour with a music legend.

The one piece of advice Jonathan offers to aspirants is, "Be Patient, Be Calm, Work Hard".

Helpful links

<https://digit.in/soundengineer>